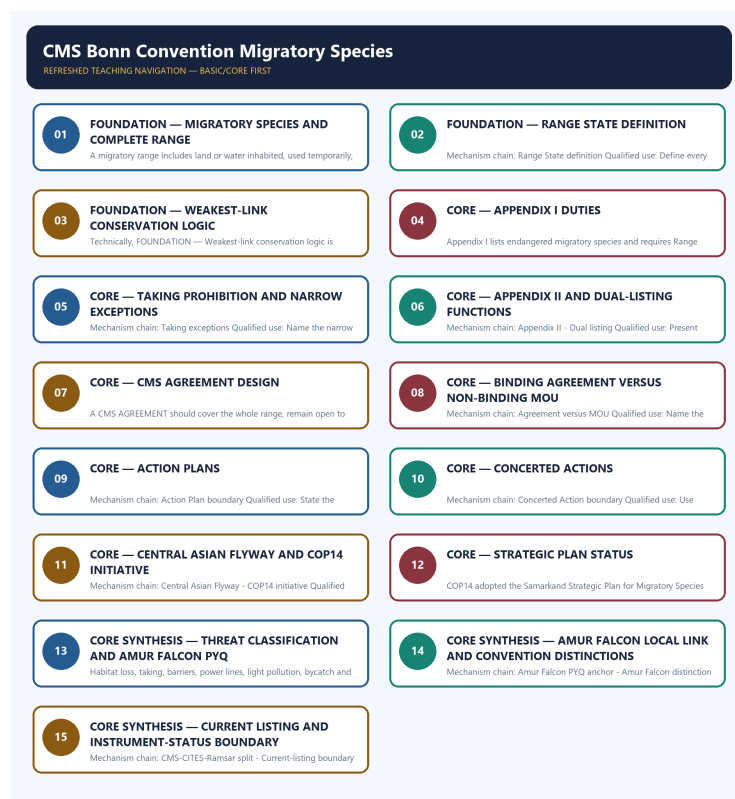


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-06.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision, ecological rate, species count or current status was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** The audited provisional 2026 routing ledger carries one Topic 10 objective demand: Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation. The provisional answer key is not recorded or inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** The CMS Convention text and official COP14 outcome release were substantively retrieved on 2026-09-06. They support definitions, Appendix mechanics, AGREEMENT design, the dated Central Asian Flyway initiative and strategic-plan adoption. No current Appendix species list, Party count, MOU count or implementation outcome was inferred.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-06. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports. Stubs, access failures, unrelated pages and thin landing pages are recorded and are not converted into ecological or current-status claims.

- <https://www.cms.int/convention-text> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official Convention text was substantively retrievable. It supports the exact migratory-species and Range State definitions, Appendix I and II duties, dual listing, taking exceptions and AGREEMENT design.
- <https://www.cms.int/en/legalinstrument/cms> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official legal-instrument page returned HTTP 403, so no separate instrument-status or membership claim was imported from it.
- <https://www.cms.int/en/news/historic-un-wildlife-meeting-concludes-major-set-actions-conservation-migratory-species-wild> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official COP14 release was substantively retrievable. It supports the Samarkand date, 2024-2032 strategic-plan adoption and the Central Asian Flyway initiative with a coordinating unit in India.
- <https://www.cms.int/en/convention-text> - attempted 2026-09-06; the redirect resolved to the substantive Convention text rather than a stub. No current Appendix species list was inferred from that text.
- <https://www.pib.gov.in/indexd.aspx?reg=3&lang=1> - attempted 2026-09-06; the request returned HTTP 403, so no Indian migratory-species announcement or action-plan outcome was imported.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Environment and Ecology Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Ecology boundary	System boundary, scale, trophic level, stock/flow, pool/flux, gross/net, unit and time interval are explicit.
Species boundary	Taxon, range, habitat, population trend, IUCN assessment, Indian legal schedule, CITES/CMS listing and endemism remain distinct.
Law/status boundary	Act, amendment, rule, notification, draft, judgment, policy, target, implementation and observed outcome remain distinct and dated.
Institution boundary	Legal form, parent authority, mandate, jurisdiction, standard, consent, enforcement, science and adjudication are not conflated.
Treaty boundary	Membership, annex/appendix, amendment acceptance, target, COP decision, national instrument and outcome remain distinct.
Climate boundary	Emission flow, concentration stock, cumulative budget, forcing, scenario, baseline, unit, mitigation, adaptation, loss-and-damage, avoidance and removal are exact.
Pollution boundary	Source, emission/load, ambient concentration, exposure, parameter, averaging period, unit, standard and jurisdiction are explicit.
Causal method	Chronology, designation, expenditure, capacity, registration and correlation are not promoted into ecological or policy outcomes without mechanism and evidence.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved : false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\basic\10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\learning-sessions\v2\subject-wide-syllabus\environment-and-ecology-10_Learning-Session.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\advanced\10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Ecological mechanisms retain direction, pool, flux, limiting factor, spatial scale and time scale.
- Current species/news claims retain taxon, source, event/publication date, assessment/listing date and access date.
- IUCN category never substitutes for Wildlife Protection Act schedule, CITES appendix, CMS appendix or endemism.
- Protected-area categories, treaty designations and institution mandates retain exact legal character.
- Acts, amendments, rules, draft instruments, notifications and judgments retain operative status and date.
- Climate figures retain unit, baseline, period, scenario and stock-flow character; global evidence is not silently downscaled to India.
- Mitigation, adaptation and loss-and-damage remain separate; allowance, offset, avoidance, removal, capture and storage remain separate.
- PYQ wording is preserved only where verified; reconstructed or routed demands remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-06:** volatile targets, standards, schedules, species status, treaty outcomes and programme claims retain source/date/status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://www.cms.int/convention-text> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official Convention text was substantively retrievable. It supports the exact migratory-species and Range State definitions, Appendix I and II duties, dual listing, taking exceptions and AGREEMENT design.
- <https://www.cms.int/en/legalinstrument/cms> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official legal-instrument page returned HTTP 403, so no separate instrument-status or membership claim was imported from it.
- <https://www.cms.int/en/news/historic-un-wildlife-meeting-concludes-major-set-actions-conservation-migratory-species-wild> - attempted 2026-09-06; the official COP14 release was substantively retrievable. It supports the Samarkand date, 2024-2032 strategic-plan adoption and the Central Asian Flyway initiative with a coordinating unit in India.
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- <https://www.pib.gov.in/indexd.aspx?reg=3&lang=1> - attempted 2026-09-06; the request returned HTTP 403, so no Indian migratory-species announcement or action-plan outcome was imported.

Topic 26 dedicated Disaster Management cross-owners (scope boundary):

- Not applicable to this topic.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - Migratory species and complete range

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Migratory species and complete range explains how Migratory-species test and Range definition fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Migratory species and complete range separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Migratory species and complete range must be read through Migratory-species test and Range definition, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Migratory**
- **species**
- **complete**
- **range**
- **Migratory-species**
- **test**

How to use them: Define Migratory, species, complete; attach range to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not call every mobile or seasonally shifting animal a CMS migratory species.

VISUAL FIRST

MIGRATORY SPECIES AND COMPLETE RANGE

01. Migratory-species test

|
v

02. Range definition

BOUNDARY -> Do not call every mobile or seasonally shifting animal a CMS migratory species.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.
- A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call every mobile or seasonally shifting animal a CMS migratory species.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Apply the cross-boundary migration test and map the complete life-cycle range.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Migratory-species test -> Range definition
- **Qualified use:** Apply the cross-boundary migration test and map the complete life-cycle range.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Migratory species complete range Migratory-species test	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Migratory-species test and Range definition through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Apply the cross-boundary migration test and map the complete life-cycle range.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not call every mobile or seasonally shifting animal a CMS migratory species.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Migratory species and complete range converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - Range State definition

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Range State definition explains how Range State definition fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Range State definition separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Range State definition must be read through Range State definition, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Range
- State
- definition
- exercises
- jurisdiction
- over

How to use them: Define Range, State, definition; attach exercises to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not reduce range to breeding and destination sites.

VISUAL FIRST

RANGE STATE DEFINITION

01. Range State definition

BOUNDARY -> Do not reduce range to breeding and destination sites.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not reduce range to breeding and destination sites.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Define every jurisdiction touching the route as potentially relevant.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Range State definition
- **Qualified use:** Define every jurisdiction touching the route as potentially relevant.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Range | State | definition | exercises | jurisdiction | over

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

connect Range State definition through ecological structure, transfer and feedback

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Define every jurisdiction touching the route as potentially relevant.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not reduce range to breeding and destination sites.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Range State definition converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - Weakest-link conservation logic

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Weakest-link conservation logic explains how Weakest-link logic fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Weakest-link conservation logic separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Weakest-link conservation logic must be read through Weakest-link logic, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Weakest-link**
- **conservation**
- **logic**
- **life**
- **cycle**
- **spans**

How to use them: Define Weakest-link, conservation, logic; attach life to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not restrict Range State to the State where breeding occurs.

VISUAL FIRST

WEAKEST-LINK CONSERVATION LOGIC

01. Weakest-link logic

BOUNDARY -> Do not restrict Range State to the State where breeding occurs.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not restrict Range State to the State where breeding occurs.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Explain why one unprotected route segment can defeat protection elsewhere.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Weakest-link logic
- **Qualified use:** Explain why one unprotected route segment can defeat protection elsewhere.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Weakest-link conservation logic life cycle spans	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Weakest-link logic through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Explain why one unprotected route segment can defeat protection elsewhere.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not restrict Range State to the State where breeding occurs.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Weakest-link conservation logic converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 4 - CORE - Appendix I duties

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Appendix I duties explains how Appendix I fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Appendix I duties separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Appendix I duties must be read through Appendix I, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Appendix
- duties
- lists
- endangered
- migratory
- species

How to use them: Define Appendix, duties, lists; attach endangered to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat Appendix I exceptions as a general taking permission.

VISUAL FIRST

APPENDIX I DUTIES

01. Appendix I

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat Appendix I exceptions as a general taking permission.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat Appendix I exceptions as a general taking permission.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** State endangered listing, habitat duties, obstacle response and taking rule.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Appendix I

- **Qualified use:** State endangered listing, habitat duties, obstacle response and taking rule.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Appendix duties lists endangered migratory species	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Appendix I through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST State endangered listing, habitat duties, obstacle response and taking rule.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat Appendix I exceptions as a general taking permission.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Appendix I duties converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 5 - CORE - Taking prohibition and narrow exceptions

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Taking prohibition and narrow exceptions explains how Taking exceptions fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Taking prohibition and narrow exceptions separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Taking prohibition and narrow exceptions must be read through Taking exceptions, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Taking
- prohibition
- narrow
- exceptions
- Appendix
- must

How to use them: Define Taking, prohibition, narrow; attach exceptions to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not say Appendix II creates the same duty as Appendix I.

VISUAL FIRST

TAKING PROHIBITION AND NARROW EXCEPTIONS

01. Taking exceptions

BOUNDARY -> Do not say Appendix II creates the same duty as Appendix I.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not say Appendix II creates the same duty as Appendix I.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Name the narrow Convention ground and retain space-time limits.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Taking exceptions
- **Qualified use:** Name the narrow Convention ground and retain space-time limits.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Taking prohibition narrow exceptions Appendix must	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Taking exceptions through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Name the narrow Convention ground and retain space-time limits.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not say Appendix II creates the same duty as Appendix I.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Taking prohibition and narrow exceptions converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 6 - CORE - Appendix II and dual-listing functions

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Appendix II and dual-listing functions explains how Appendix II and Dual listing fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Appendix II and dual-listing functions separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Appendix II and dual-listing functions must be read through Appendix II and Dual listing, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Appendix
- dual-listing
- functions
- Dual

- listing
- covers

How to use them: Define Appendix, dual-listing, functions; attach Dual to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Appendix I and II are not mutually exclusive; dual listing serves separate functions.

VISUAL FIRST

APPENDIX II AND DUAL-LISTING FUNCTIONS

01. Appendix II

|

v

02. Dual listing

BOUNDARY -> Appendix I and II are not mutually exclusive; dual listing serves separate functions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.
- The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Appendix I and II are not mutually exclusive; dual listing serves separate functions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Present Appendix II and simultaneous listing through their distinct functions.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Appendix II -> Dual listing
- **Qualified use:** Present Appendix II and simultaneous listing through their distinct functions.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Appendix dual-listing functions Dual listing covers	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Appendix II and Dual listing through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Present Appendix II and simultaneous listing through their distinct functions.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Appendix I and II are not mutually exclusive; dual listing serves separate functions.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Appendix II and dual-listing functions converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 7 - CORE - CMS AGREEMENT design

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CMS AGREEMENT design explains how AGREEMENT architecture fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, CMS AGREEMENT design separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

CMS AGREEMENT design must be read through AGREEMENT architecture, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- AGREEMENT
- design
- architecture
- should
- cover
- whole

How to use them: Define AGREEMENT, design, architecture; attach should to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat every CMS instrument as legally binding.

VISUAL FIRST

CMS AGREEMENT DESIGN

01. AGREEMENT architecture

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat every CMS instrument as legally binding.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat every CMS instrument as legally binding.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Describe whole-range and open-to-Range-States agreement design.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** AGREEMENT architecture
- **Qualified use:** Describe whole-range and open-to-Range-States agreement design.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS AGREEMENT design architecture should cover whole	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect AGREEMENT architecture through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Describe whole-range and open-to-Range-States agreement design.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat every CMS instrument as legally binding.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CMS AGREEMENT design converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion

SESSION 8 - CORE - Binding Agreement versus non-binding MOU

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Binding Agreement versus non-binding MOU explains how Agreement versus MOU fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Binding Agreement versus non-binding MOU separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Binding Agreement versus non-binding MOU must be read through Agreement versus MOU, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Binding
- Agreement
- versus
- non-binding
- Memorandum
- Understanding

How to use them: Define Binding, Agreement, versus; attach non-binding to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not call an Action Plan an Agreement or MOU without the instrument.

VISUAL FIRST

BINDING AGREEMENT VERSUS NON-BINDING MOU

01. Agreement versus MOU

BOUNDARY -> Do not call an Action Plan an Agreement or MOU without the instrument.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call an Action Plan an Agreement or MOU without the instrument.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Name the exact instrument and its binding status.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Agreement versus MOU
- **Qualified use:** Name the exact instrument and its binding status.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Binding Agreement versus non-binding Memorandum Understanding	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Agreement versus MOU through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Name the exact instrument and its binding status.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not call an Action Plan an Agreement or MOU without the instrument.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Binding Agreement versus non-binding MOU converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 9 - CORE - Action Plans

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Action Plans explains how Action Plan boundary fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Action Plans separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Action Plans must be read through Action Plan boundary, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Action**
- **Plans**
- **Plan**
- **boundary**
- **organise**
- **conservation**

How to use them: Define Action, Plans, Plan; attach boundary to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not convert a Concerted Action into an Appendix amendment.

VISUAL FIRST

ACTION PLANS

01. Action Plan boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not convert a Concerted Action into an Appendix amendment.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not convert a Concerted Action into an Appendix amendment.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** State the plan's measures without upgrading its legal status or outcomes.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Action Plan boundary
- **Qualified use:** State the plan's measures without upgrading its legal status or outcomes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Action Plans Plan boundary organise conservation	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Action Plan boundary through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST State the plan's measures without upgrading its legal status or outcomes.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not convert a Concerted Action into an Appendix amendment.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Action Plans converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 10 - CORE - Concerted Actions

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Concerted Actions explains how Concerted Action boundary fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Concerted Actions separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Concerted Actions must be read through Concerted Action boundary, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Concerted**
- **Actions**
- **Action**
- **boundary**

- prioritise
- focused

How to use them: Define Concerted, Actions, Action; attach boundary to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not call the Central Asian Flyway a treaty.

VISUAL FIRST

CONCERTED ACTIONS

01. Concerted Action boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not call the Central Asian Flyway a treaty.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call the Central Asian Flyway a treaty.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use priority action as an operational bridge, not a new listing.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Concerted Action boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use priority action as an operational bridge, not a new listing.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Concerted Actions Action boundary prioritise focused	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Concerted Action boundary through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Use priority action as an operational bridge, not a new listing.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not call the Central Asian Flyway a treaty.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Concerted Actions converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 11 - CORE - Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative explains how Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative must be read through Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Central
- Asian
- Flyway
- initiative
- route
- cooperation

How to use them: Define Central, Asian, Flyway; attach initiative to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not upgrade the COP14 initiative to a binding Agreement.

VISUAL FIRST

CENTRAL ASIAN FLYWAY AND COP14 INITIATIVE

01. Central Asian Flyway

|

v

02. COP14 initiative

BOUNDARY -> Do not upgrade the COP14 initiative to a binding Agreement.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.
- The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not upgrade the COP14 initiative to a binding Agreement.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Describe the flyway separately from the COP14 initiative and its coordinating unit.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Central Asian Flyway -> COP14 initiative
- **Qualified use:** Describe the flyway separately from the COP14 initiative and its coordinating unit.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Central Asian Flyway initiative route cooperation	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Describe the flyway separately from the COP14 initiative and its coordinating unit.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not upgrade the COP14 initiative to a binding Agreement.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Central Asian Flyway and COP14 initiative converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 12 - CORE - Strategic plan status

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Strategic plan status explains how Strategic plan status fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Strategic plan status separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Strategic plan status must be read through Strategic plan status, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Strategic**
- **plan**
- **status**
- **adopted**
- **Samarkand**
- **Migratory**

How to use them: Define Strategic, plan, status; attach adopted to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not report a strategic-plan target as a conservation outcome.

VISUAL FIRST

STRATEGIC PLAN STATUS

01. Strategic plan status

BOUNDARY -> Do not report a strategic-plan target as a conservation outcome.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not report a strategic-plan target as a conservation outcome.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate adopted initiative and targets from achieved conservation results.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Strategic plan status
- **Qualified use:** Separate adopted initiative and targets from achieved conservation results.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Strategic plan status adopted Samarkand Migratory	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Strategic plan status through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate adopted initiative and targets from achieved conservation results.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not report a strategic-plan target as a conservation outcome.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Strategic plan status converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Threat classification and Amur Falcon PYQ

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Threat classification and Amur Falcon PYQ explains how Threat classification fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Threat classification and Amur Falcon PYQ separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Threat classification and Amur Falcon PYQ must be read through Threat classification, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Threat
- classification
- Amur
- Falcon
- Habitat
- loss

How to use them: Define Threat, classification, Amur; attach Falcon to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not classify every threat as a transboundary failure.

VISUAL FIRST

THREAT CLASSIFICATION AND AMUR FALCON PYQ

01. Threat classification

BOUNDARY -> Do not classify every threat as a transboundary failure.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not classify every threat as a transboundary failure.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Classify the threat and carry the provisional Amur Falcon concept without a key.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Threat classification
- **Qualified use:** Classify the threat and carry the provisional Amur Falcon concept without a key.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Threat classification Amur Falcon Habitat loss	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Threat classification through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Classify the threat and carry the provisional Amur Falcon concept without a key.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not classify every threat as a transboundary failure.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Threat classification and Amur Falcon PYQ converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Amur Falcon local link and convention distinctions

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Amur Falcon local link and convention distinctions explains how Amur Falcon PYQ anchor and Amur Falcon distinction fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Amur Falcon local link and convention distinctions separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Amur Falcon local link and convention distinctions must be read through Amur Falcon PYQ anchor and Amur Falcon distinction, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Amur
- Falcon
- local
- link
- convention
- distinctions

How to use them: Define Amur, Falcon, local; attach link to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not infer the 2026 provisional PYQ key.

VISUAL FIRST

AMUR FALCON LOCAL LINK AND CONVENTION DISTINCTIONS

01. Amur Falcon PYQ anchor

|

v

02. Amur Falcon distinction

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer the 2026 provisional PYQ key.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.
- The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer the 2026 provisional PYQ key.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use the local stopover link, then distinguish CMS, CITES and Ramsar.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Amur Falcon PYQ anchor -> Amur Falcon distinction
- **Qualified use:** Use the local stopover link, then distinguish CMS, CITES and Ramsar.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Amur Falcon local link convention distinctions	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Amur Falcon PYQ anchor and Amur Falcon distinction through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Use the local stopover link, then distinguish CMS, CITES and Ramsar.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not infer the 2026 provisional PYQ key.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Amur Falcon local link and convention distinctions converts a precise ecological distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Current listing and instrument-status boundary

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Current listing and instrument-status boundary explains how CMS-CITES-Ramsar split and Current-listing boundary fit into one examinable ecological mechanism.

Technical definition: In Environment and Ecology, Current listing and instrument-status boundary separates the ecosystem or landscape boundary from the ecological level, state variable, transfer process, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, source status and legal or scientific designation attached to the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Current listing and instrument-status boundary must be read through CMS-CITES-Ramsar split and Current-listing boundary, with the ecological level, system boundary and measured parameter fixed before the inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- listing
- instrument-status
- boundary
- CMS-CITES-Ramsar
- split
- Current-listing

How to use them: Define listing, instrument-status, boundary; attach CMS-CITES-Ramsar to its source, ecological scale and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not invent a current Appendix or membership count.

VISUAL FIRST

CURRENT LISTING AND INSTRUMENT-STATUS BOUNDARY

01. CMS-CITES-Ramsar split

|
v

02. Current-listing boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not invent a current Appendix or membership count.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.
- The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not invent a current Appendix or membership count.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Close without inventing current listings, Parties or instrument status.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** CMS-CITES-Ramsar split -> Current-listing boundary
- **Qualified use:** Close without inventing current listings, Parties or instrument status.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS listing instrument-status boundary CMS-CITES-Ramsar split Current-listing	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect CMS-CITES-Ramsar split and Current-listing boundary through ecological structure, transfer and feedback	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Close without inventing current listings, Parties or instrument status.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not invent a current Appendix or membership count.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II international-cooperation linkage. **Core area:** Range-state cooperation for migratory species. **Grounded in:** Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS/Bonn Convention, 1979) official framework; CMS CoP13 (India, 2020) outcomes; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. *Companion:* advanced/10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md.

1. Visual foundation

CMS APPENDIX STRUCTURE (Bonn Convention, 1979)

Appendix I -> ENDANGERED migratory species -> range states must STRICTLY PROTECT (prohibit taking, conserve/restore habitat)

Appendix II -> species needing/benefiting from international cooperation -> range states encouraged to conclude AGREEMENTS (regional/species-specific instruments) for coordinated conservation across their entire migratory range

KEY IDEA: A migratory species crosses MULTIPLE COUNTRIES' jurisdictions in its life cycle, so no single national law can protect it fully -> CMS exists to coordinate "RANGE STATES."

Core proposition: CMS (the Bonn Convention) is the multilateral framework specifically addressing species whose survival depends on protection across an entire migratory range spanning multiple countries - its logic is range-state coordination, distinct from CITES' trade focus and from any single country's domestic wildlife law.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: CMS / Bonn Convention (1979)	UN Environment Programme-administered treaty for conserving migratory species across their range, signed at Bonn, Germany.
FACT: Range state	Any country whose jurisdiction a migratory species' range passes through at any point in its life cycle.
FACT: CMS Appendix I	Endangered migratory species requiring strict protection and habitat conservation/restoration by all range states.
FACT: CMS Appendix II	Migratory species with unfavourable conservation status (or that would benefit significantly from international cooperation), for which range states are encouraged to conclude specific Agreements.
FACT: CMS Agreement/MOU	A binding Agreement or non-binding Memorandum of Understanding concluded under CMS among relevant range states for a specific species or species group (e.g., raptors, dugongs, sharks).

3. Topic mechanism

1. A migratory species (bird, mammal, fish, insect) may breed in one country, stop over in several others, and winter in yet another - meaning its conservation cannot succeed if even one critical range state fails to protect it at a key life-cycle stage.
2. CMS Appendix I obliges range states to prohibit taking (except in narrow exceptions) and to conserve/restore habitats critical to the species, with special attention to preventing/removing obstacles (e.g., structures) that impede migration.
3. CMS Appendix II encourages (rather than strictly mandates) range states to negotiate specific Agreements or Memoranda of Understanding tailored to a species or species group, allowing flexible, regionally appropriate cooperation mechanisms.

4. CMS periodically reviews and updates Appendix listings and adopts new species-specific Agreements/MOUs at its Conference of the Parties (CoP), held roughly every three years.

5. India, as a range state along major flyways (notably the Central Asian Flyway for migratory birds), participates in CMS-linked cooperation to protect migratory birds, marine species (e.g., dugongs, marine turtles) and terrestrial migrants moving through or near its territory.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **CMS Secretariat (administered under UNEP, headquartered in Bonn, Germany):**

coordinates the Convention's implementation and Conference of the Parties.

- FACT: **MoEFCC:** India's nodal ministry for CMS implementation and Conference of the Parties participation.

- FACT: **Wildlife Institute of India (WII):** provides scientific/technical input on migratory-species tracking and habitat assessment (e.g., satellite telemetry studies).

- ANALYSIS: Regional flyway-specific coordination (e.g., Central Asian Flyway range states) functions as an informal-to-formal cooperative mechanism linked to, but not always a fully binding CMS Agreement, for migratory bird conservation across South and Central Asia.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: India hosted the 13th Conference of the Parties to CMS (CMS CoP13) in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, in 2020, where India held the CMS Presidency for the following three-year term and various species-specific outcomes were adopted, including attention to the Great Indian Bustard and Bengal Florican among Central Asian Flyway species.

- ANALYSIS: The dugong (a marine mammal found in India's coastal waters, e.g., Gulf of Mannar and Andaman-Nicobar waters) is a CMS-listed migratory marine species subject to specific conservation attention including a dedicated MOU framework.

- ANALYSIS: Migratory raptors and waterfowl using the Central Asian Flyway (which passes through India) illustrate the range-state coordination logic - protecting only Indian wetlands without corresponding protection in Central Asian breeding/staging grounds would be insufficient for species recovery.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: CMS (Bonn Convention, 1979) is administered under UNEP and focuses specifically on migratory species conservation across their entire range.

- FACT: CMS has two main Appendices: Appendix I (strict protection) and Appendix II (cooperation encouraged through specific Agreements/MOUs).

- FACT: India hosted CMS CoP13 in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, in 2020, and subsequently held the CMS Presidency.

- FACT: A "range state" is any country through which a migratory species passes during its life cycle, not just its breeding or final destination country.

- FACT: The dugong and various Central Asian Flyway birds are prominent Indian examples of CMS-relevant migratory species.

- FACT: **India has been a Party to CMS since 1983.** It is a signatory to four CMS species-specific **non-legally-binding MOUs**: the **Siberian Crane**, **Marine Turtles** (Indian Ocean-South-East Asian region), **Dugong**, and **Raptors (Birds of Prey)** MOUs.

- FACT: A species may be listed on **both** Appendix I and Appendix II simultaneously - the two Appendices serve different functions (strict protection vs cooperative agreement) rather than being mutually exclusive tiers.

- FACT: CMS's "**Concerted Actions**" mechanism designates priority species/populations for

focused, time-bound cooperative measures between CoPs - the operational bridge between an Appendix listing and on-ground work.

- FACT: CMS CoP13 (Gandhinagar, 2020) had the Great Indian Bustard-inspired mascot "**Gibi**", the theme "*Migratory species connect the planet and we welcome them home*", and produced the **Gandhinagar Declaration** highlighting migratory species' role in ecological connectivity.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: CMS regulates international trade in migratory species like CITES does. -> CMS focuses on habitat protection and range-state cooperation for conservation, not trade regulation (that is CITES' function).
- WRONG: Only the country where a species breeds is considered its "range state." -> Any country the species passes through during its life cycle qualifies as a range state.
- WRONG: CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I. -> Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.
- WRONG: India has never hosted a major CMS event. -> India hosted CMS CoP13 in Gandhinagar in 2020 and held the subsequent CMS Presidency.
- WRONG: CMS only covers birds. -> It covers migratory mammals, fish, reptiles and insects as well as birds (e.g., dugongs, sharks, marine turtles).
- WRONG: A species must be on either Appendix I or Appendix II, never both. -> Dual listing is common and deliberate: Appendix I imposes protection duties, Appendix II opens the route to a cooperative Agreement/MOU.
- WRONG: All CMS instruments are legally binding. -> CMS supports both binding **Agreements** and non-binding **Memoranda of Understanding**; all four instruments India has signed under CMS are MOUs, not binding Agreements.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: **CMS COP14, Samarkand (February 2024)**: adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032, launched the first *State of the World's Migratory Species* report and advanced a Central Asian Flyway initiative with a coordinating unit in India.
- FACT: India's COP13 hosting/presidency remains historical context; COP14 is the current completed COP anchor. CMS outcome.
- FACT: **Historical context**: India's CMS COP13 Presidency (Gandhinagar, 2020. shaped its subsequent Central Asian Flyway engagement; do not present COP13 as the latest completed COP.

ANALYSIS: **Interpretation caution**: CMS CoP outcomes and Appendix updates occur periodically - always cite the specific CoP year when referencing a listing or Agreement status. CMS CoPs meet roughly triennially, so a CoP after Samarkand (2024) may have occurred by the time an answer is written; verify on cms.int rather than assuming COP14 is still the latest. Distinguish also between a species being **proposed** for listing at a CoP and a proposal being **adopted** - only the latter changes legal status.

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: identify CMS's distinct focus (range-state, migratory-species cooperation) versus CITES (trade regulation) and Ramsar (wetland-specific).
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the Central Asian Flyway and dugong examples are used to argue for transboundary cooperation as essential to migratory-species conservation.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Argue that migratory-species conservation inherently requires transboundary

cooperation - no single range state's domestic law, however strong, can succeed alone.

- ANALYSIS: Use India's CMS CoP13 hosting/Presidency to argue for India's active leadership role in shaping migratory-species conservation diplomacy, particularly for the Central Asian Flyway.
- ANALYSIS: Conclude with a range-state-coordination thesis: durable migratory-species conservation needs synchronised habitat protection and threat mitigation (e.g., power-line collision, poaching) across every country the species passes through.

Answer thesis: Distinguish CMS's range-state-cooperation, habitat-focused mandate from CITES' trade-regulation mandate, and use India's active CMS engagement (CoP13 hosting/Presidency) to argue that migratory-species survival depends on coordinated action across every country in the species' range, not unilateral domestic protection alone.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Distinguish CMS Appendix I and Appendix II obligations and define "range state."
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Why can migratory-species conservation not succeed through a single country's domestic law alone?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Discuss India's role in CMS, including its CoP13 hosting and Presidency, in strengthening Central Asian Flyway conservation.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: [advanced/10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md](#).
- FACT: [09_CITES-and-Wildlife-Trade.md](#) - the trade-focused counterpart convention, contrasted here.
- FACT: [07_Biosphere-Reserves-and-Ramsar-Sites.md](#) - wetland stopover-habitat protection relevant to migratory birds.
- FACT: [05_IUCN-Red-List-and-Endemism.md](#) - extinction-risk assessment for CMS-listed species like the Great Indian Bustard.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: [_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md](#). **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	27	Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

13. Core answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Demand decoder and thesis

- Define the **range-state life-cycle problem** before listing appendices. Then identify whether the threat is transboundary coordination or a domestic implementation failure.
- **Thesis:** migratory-species conservation is a weakest-link problem; CMS supplies graded cooperation, but a plan or MOU is not evidence of protection on each route segment.

13.2 Reusable evidence units

Claim	Named evidence/example -> significance	Qualification
Legal weight varies within CMS.	Appendix I, Appendix II, Agreements and MOUs -> separates strict-protection duties from cooperative instruments.	Do not call every CMS instrument legally binding.
Flyway protection needs local action as well as diplomacy.	Amur Falcon at Doyang/Pangti, Nagaland -> community protection of a stopover can repair one vulnerable link in a long route.	One local success does not establish protection along the whole flyway.
The latest completed anchor matters.	CMS COP14, Samarkand 2024 -> Strategic Plan/first global report are process and assessment milestones.	Do not convert adoption of a plan into a species-recovery outcome.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

- **10 marks:** define range state, distinguish appendices and use Amur Falcon as a mechanism case.
- **15/20 marks:** map flyway stages, use a cooperative and a domestic mitigation example, discuss habitat/power-line/poaching risks and end with synchronised range-state plus local-community action.

Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Official syllabus/index and owned core:** urbanisation is a change in urban share plus occupational, spatial, economic and institutional transformation. Urban population growth may arise through natural increase, migration, reclassification or boundary expansion; statutory town, census town, agglomeration, metropolitan region, slum and informal settlement are not synonyms.
- **Indispensable sociology and urban process:** agglomeration can deepen labour markets, matching, supplier networks and knowledge spillovers, while land-price escalation, housing-supply lag, commuting cost and environmental externalities distribute gains and costs unevenly. Migration is rational for households even when it stresses the city.
- **Governance precision:** the Seventy-fourth Constitutional Amendment inserted Part IXA and the Twelfth Schedule, but functional listing, actual devolution, municipal finance, parastatal control, metropolitan coordination and ward-level participation are separate questions. A metropolitan region is not one municipality and formal assignment is not implementation capacity.
- **Housing and informality:** informality is a labour, housing, tenure and service relation, not a cultural trait. A slum label depends on legal/Census/ local definitions; tenure insecurity can block formal services, while remote relocation can destroy livelihood access even where housing quality improves.
- **Remedy test:** compare in-situ upgrading, serviced land, rental and affordable housing, transit-oriented planning, portable services, drainage/ecological restoration, municipal finance, ward participation and metropolitan coordination by distributive and procedural justice, resilience and livelihood access. No remedy works merely because it is technology-labelled.
- **Data/source control and current programme boundary:** Census 2011 remains the latest completed

Indian urban stock as of 5 September 2026; UN World Urbanization Prospects 2025 is a harmonised estimate/projection, not Census data. PMAY-U 2.0 and AMRUT 2.0 may establish current housing and service-policy context, but project counts, coverage and benefit claims require dated dashboard evidence and detailed scheme architecture remains Social Justice/Governance-owned.

- **Four-ledger hostile audit:** literal syllabus, prerequisites, textbook

taxonomy and PYQs were checked for growth-component separation, city-size pull, governance fragmentation, housing/informality mechanisms, ecological risk, justice tests and evidence limits.

- **Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2026:** direct routes cover 2022 Tier-2

city/middle-class consumption, 2023 segregation, cross-owned 2024 large-city migrant pull and 2025 smart-city poverty/distributive justice. No unavailable 2026 demand or unsupported city-level statistic is invented.

ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** CMS conserves migratory species across range states through appendices and subsidiary agreements or memoranda, addressing threats along routes and habitats.
- **Close distinction:** Appendix I and II have distinct consequences, CMS is not CITES, range state is not breeding state only, and a COP listing is not proof of domestic recovery.
- **Mechanism / status / evidence limit:** Verify membership, appendix, taxon, range and instrument status; date COP outcomes and separate treaty obligation, subsidiary instrument, national action and population trend.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Migratory-species test?

A. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. B. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. C. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. D. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

Answer: A. Explanation: The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Migratory-species test?

A. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. B. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. C. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. D. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

Answer: B. Explanation: The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Migratory-species test without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. B. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. C. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. D. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

Answer: C. Explanation: The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Migratory-species test?

A. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. B. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. C. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. D. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.

Answer: D. Explanation: The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Range definition?

A. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. B. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. C. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. D. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

Answer: A. Explanation: A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Range definition?

A. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. B. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. C. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. D. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

Answer: B. Explanation: A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Range definition without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. B. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. C. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. D. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.

Answer: C. Explanation: A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Range definition?

A. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. B. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. C. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. D. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

Answer: D. Explanation: A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Range State definition?

A. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. B. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. C. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. D. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Range State definition?

A. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. B. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. C. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. D. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Range State definition without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. B. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. C. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. D. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Range State definition?

A. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. B. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. C. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. D. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Weakest-link logic?

A. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. B. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. C. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. D. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.

Answer: A. Explanation: Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Weakest-link logic?

A. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. B. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. C. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. D. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Weakest-link logic without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. B. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. C. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. D. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

Answer: C. Explanation: Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Weakest-link logic?

A. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. B. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. C. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. D. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

Answer: D. Explanation: Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Appendix I?

A. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. B. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. C. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. D. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appendix I?

A. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. B. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. C. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. D. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

Answer: B. Explanation: Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Appendix I without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. B. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. C. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. D. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

Answer: C. Explanation: Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appendix I?

A. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. B. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. C. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. D. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Taking exceptions?

A. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. B. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. C. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. D. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

Answer: A. Explanation: Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Taking exceptions?

A. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. B. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. C. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. D. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

Answer: B. Explanation: Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Taking exceptions without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. B. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. C. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. D. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Taking exceptions?

A. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. B. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. C. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. D. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.

Answer: D. Explanation: Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Appendix II?

A. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. B. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. C. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. D. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

Answer: A. Explanation: Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appendix II?

A. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. B. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. C. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. D. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Appendix II without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. B. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. C. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. D. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

Answer: C. Explanation: Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appendix II?

A. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. B. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. C. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. D. Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.

Answer: D. Explanation: Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Dual listing?

A. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. B. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. C. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. D. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Dual listing?

A. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. B. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. C. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. D. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Dual listing without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. B. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. C. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. D. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Dual listing?

A. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. B. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. C. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. D. The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. The other

options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies AGREEMENT architecture?

A. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. B. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. C. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. D. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

Answer: A. Explanation: A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of AGREEMENT architecture?

A. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. B. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. C. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. D. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.

Answer: B. Explanation: A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses AGREEMENT architecture without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. B. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. C. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. D. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

Answer: C. Explanation: A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about AGREEMENT architecture?

A. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. B. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. C. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. D. A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.

Answer: D. Explanation: A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Agreement versus MOU?

A. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. B. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. C. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. D. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.

Answer: A. Explanation: A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Agreement versus MOU?

A. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. B. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. C. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. D. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

Answer: B. Explanation: A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Agreement versus MOU without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. B. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. C. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. D. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

Answer: C. Explanation: A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Agreement versus MOU?

A. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. B. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. C. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. D. A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.

Answer: D. Explanation: A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Action Plan boundary?

A. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. B. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. C. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. D. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

Answer: A. Explanation: An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Action Plan boundary?

A. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. B. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. C. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. D. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

Answer: B. Explanation: An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Action Plan boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. B. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. C. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. D. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

Answer: C. Explanation: An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Action Plan boundary?

A. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. B. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. C. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. D. An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Concerted Action boundary?

A. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. B. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. C. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. D. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

Answer: A. Explanation: CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Concerted Action boundary?

A. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. B. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. C. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. D. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

Answer: B. Explanation: CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Concerted Action boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. B. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. C. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. D. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

Answer: C. Explanation: CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Concerted Action boundary?

A. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. B. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. C. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. D. CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

Answer: D. Explanation: CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Central Asian Flyway?

A. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. B. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. C. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. D. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

Answer: A. Explanation: The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Central Asian Flyway?

A. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. B. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. C. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. D. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

Answer: B. Explanation: The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official

instrument. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Central Asian Flyway without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. B. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. C. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. D. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

Answer: C. Explanation: The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Central Asian Flyway?

A. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. B. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. C. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. D. The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.

Answer: D. Explanation: The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies COP14 initiative?

A. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. B. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. C. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. D. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

Answer: A. Explanation: The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of COP14 initiative?

A. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. B. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. C. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. D. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

Answer: B. Explanation: The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses COP14 initiative without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. B. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. C. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. D. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.

Answer: C. Explanation: The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about COP14 initiative?

A. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. B. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. C. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. D. The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.

Answer: D. Explanation: The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Strategic plan status?

A. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. B. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. C. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. D. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

Answer: A. Explanation: COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Strategic plan status?

A. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. B. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. C. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. D. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.

Answer: B. Explanation: COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Strategic plan status without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. B. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. C. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. D. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

Answer: C. Explanation: COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Strategic plan status?

A. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. B. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. C. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. D. COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

Answer: D. Explanation: COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Threat classification?

A. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. B. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. C. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. D. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.

Answer: A. Explanation: Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Threat classification?

A. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. B. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. C. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. D. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

Answer: B. Explanation: Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Threat classification without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. B. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. C. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. D. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.

Answer: C. Explanation: Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Threat classification?

A. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. B. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. C. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. D. Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.

Answer: D. Explanation: Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?

A. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. B. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. C. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. D. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

Answer: A. Explanation: The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 5. Claim and named evidence:** D. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or

legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?

A. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. B. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. C. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. D. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.

Answer: B. Explanation: The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: Treat "Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit,

exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?"

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. B. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. C. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. D. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

Answer: C. Explanation: The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or status?"

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q67. Which statement uses Amur Falcon PYQ anchor without changing its scale, parameter or...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?

A. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. B. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. C. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. D. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

Answer: D. Explanation: The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales,

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon distinction?

A. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. B. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. C. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. D. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Amur Falcon distinction?

A. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. B. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. C. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. D. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Amur Falcon distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. B. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. C. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. D. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon distinction?

A. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. B. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. C. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. D. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies CMS-CITES-Ramsar split?

A. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. B. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. C. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. D. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.

Answer: A. Explanation: CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CMS-CITES-Ramsar split?

A. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. B. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. C. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. D. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

Answer: B. Explanation: CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses CMS-CITES-Ramsar split without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. B. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. C. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. D. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

Answer: C. Explanation: CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CMS-CITES-Ramsar split?

A. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. B. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. C. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. D. CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.

Answer: D. Explanation: CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Current-listing boundary?

A. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. B. The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. C. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. D. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

Answer: A. Explanation: The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Current-listing boundary?

A. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. B. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. C. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. D. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.

Answer: B. Explanation: The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Current-listing boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. B. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. C. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. D. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current-listing boundary?

A. Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. B. Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. C. Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. D. The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

Answer: D. Explanation: The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat "Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- Claim and named evidence:** B. A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:**

State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Amur Falcon distinction? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?"

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Amur Falcon PYQ anchor?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

PROVISIONAL OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

The audited provisional 2026 routing ledger carries one Topic 10 objective demand: Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation. The provisional answer key is not recorded or inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: identify CMS's distinct focus (range-state, migratory-species cooperation) versus CITES (trade regulation) and Ramsar (wetland-specific).
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the Central Asian Flyway and dugong examples are used to argue for transboundary cooperation as essential to migratory-species conservation.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I

- Routed question demands: 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	27	Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans- ■2026- ■GS1- ■Provis ional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions distinguishing CMS Appendix I/II obligations from Agreements/MOUs should be solved by applying the graduated binding-versus-voluntary toolkit logic.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on migratory-species conservation should explicitly identify whether the cited threat is a range-state-coordination problem (requiring CMS-type cooperation) or a domestic-implementation problem (requiring purely national fixes) to show precise analytical framing.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Define a CMS migratory species, its range and a Range State. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflown on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.
- A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflown on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.
- A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Define a CMS migratory species, its range and a Range State. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Define a CMS migratory species, its range and a Range State. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish CMS Appendix I, Appendix II and dual listing. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Appendix I. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taking exceptions. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appendix II. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix II covers

migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dual listing. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.
- Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.
- Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.
- The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Appendix I. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taking exceptions. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appendix II. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dual listing. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish CMS Appendix I, Appendix II and dual listing. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Appendix I. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level,

legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taking exceptions. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appendix II. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dual listing. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Appendix I. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taking exceptions. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appendix II. **Named evidence/example:** Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dual listing. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish CMS Appendix I, Appendix II and dual listing. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the legal and functional differences among Agreements, MOUs, Action Plans and Concerted Actions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** AGREEMENT architecture. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Agreement versus MOU. **Named evidence/example:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Action Plan boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Concerted Action boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.
- A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.
- An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.
- CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: AGREEMENT architecture. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Agreement versus MOU. **Named evidence/example:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Action Plan boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Concerted Action boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the legal and functional differences among Agreements, MOUs, Action Plans and...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: AGREEMENT architecture. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Agreement versus MOU. **Named evidence/example:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Action Plan boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Concerted Action boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic

legal protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: AGREEMENT architecture. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Agreement versus MOU. **Named evidence/example:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Action Plan boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Concerted Action boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the legal and functional differences among Agreements, MOUs, Action Plans and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the Central Asian Flyway's status after CMS COP14 without overstating the instrument or outcome. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** COP14 initiative. **Named evidence/example:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Strategic plan status. **Named evidence/example:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.
- The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.
- COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** COP14 initiative. **Named evidence/example:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than

generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Strategic plan status. **Named evidence/example:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the Central Asian Flyway's status after CMS COP14 without overstating the instrument...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** COP14 initiative. **Named evidence/example:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Strategic plan status. **Named evidence/example:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system

boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** COP14 initiative. **Named evidence/example:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Strategic plan status. **Named evidence/example:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the Central Asian Flyway's status after CMS COP14 without overstating the instrument...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess migratory-species conservation as a weakest-link problem requiring both international and domestic action. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threat classification. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove

protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.
- A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.
- Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.
- Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.
- The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threat classification. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess migratory-species conservation as a weakest-link problem requiring both international...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than

generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threat classification. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Range definition. **Named evidence/example:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range State definition. **Named evidence/example:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threat classification. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess migratory-species conservation as a weakest-link problem requiring both international...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Use the Amur Falcon route to build a source-disciplined CMS answer. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary

problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon PYQ anchor. **Named evidence/example:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-CITES-Ramsar split. **Named evidence/example:** CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.
- Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.
- The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.
- The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.
- The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.
- CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.
- The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage,

taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon PYQ anchor. **Named evidence/example:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-CITES-Ramsar split. **Named evidence/example:** CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Use the Amur Falcon route to build a source-disciplined CMS answer. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must

retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon PYQ anchor. **Named evidence/example:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-CITES-Ramsar split. **Named evidence/example:** CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Migratory-species test. **Named evidence/example:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Weakest-link logic. **Named evidence/example:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central Asian Flyway. **Named evidence/example:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Amur Falcon PYQ anchor. **Named evidence/example:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

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Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the

claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Use the Amur Falcon route to build a source-disciplined CMS answer. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II international-cooperation linkage. **Core area:** Range-state cooperation for migratory species. **Grounded in:** CMS treaty text and CoP13 (Gandhinagar, 2020) outcomes; CMS Central Asian Flyway initiative documents; Supreme Court Great Indian Bustard proceedings; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. **Companion:** basic/10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md.

1. Why CMS is structurally the "weakest-link" conservation problem

ANALYSIS: The defining analytical feature of migratory-species conservation is that species-level outcomes are only as strong as the *weakest-protected* range state in the entire migratory circuit. A species can receive rigorous protection in India (breeding/wintering ground) yet still decline because of unregulated hunting, habitat loss or unmitigated infrastructure hazards (e.g., wind turbines, power lines) in another range state along its route. This "weakest-link" framing is the central reason CMS exists as a coordination mechanism rather than leaving migratory-species protection purely to bilateral or unilateral domestic action.

2. CMS instruments: a graduated cooperation toolkit

Instrument	Legal weight	Illustrative CMS example
FACT: Appendix I listing	Binding strict-protection obligation on all range states.	Requires prohibition of taking and habitat conservation/restoration duties.
FACT: Appendix II listing	Non-binding encouragement to negotiate a specific Agreement.	Basis for concluding tailored regional/species instruments.
FACT: CMS Agreement (legally binding among signatories)	Binding on the specific range states that sign it.	E.g., agreements for specific taxa such as certain raptors or aquatic mammals in defined regions.
FACT: CMS Memorandum of Understanding (MOU, non-binding)	Voluntary cooperative framework, more flexible/faster to conclude than a binding Agreement.	Used for species/initiatives such as dugong conservation and various flyway-coordination arrangements.

ANALYSIS: Analytical point: this graduated toolkit - from binding Appendix I duties down to voluntary MOUs - reflects a deliberate design trade-off: stronger legal instruments (binding Agreements) are harder to negotiate and achieve universal range-state buy-in, while weaker instruments (MOUs) are easier to conclude but rely on voluntary compliance. A sophisticated Mains answer should note that CMS's overall effectiveness depends on which instrument tier a given species' conservation actually operates under, not just whether it is "CMS-listed."

3. The Central Asian Flyway: a case study in incomplete institutionalisation

1. **ANALYSIS:** Unlike some other major flyways worldwide that have long-standing, well-resourced

formal flyway-partnership institutions, the Central Asian Flyway (spanning Arctic Russia/Central Asia through South Asia to the Indian Ocean, and passing directly through India) has historically had a comparatively less formalised institutional/coordination architecture, despite CMS-linked efforts (including a CMS Action Plan framework) to strengthen range-state cooperation along it.

2. ANALYSIS: **Analytical significance:** this institutional gap is directly relevant to species

like the Amur Falcon (a long-distance migrant partly reliant on safe passage/stopover conditions across this flyway) and various waterfowl - conservation success depends on coordinated protection across multiple, institutionally uneven range states, making the Central Asian Flyway a frequently cited example of the "weakest-link" problem in practice.

3. ANALYSIS: India's hosting of CMS CoP13 (Gandhinagar, 2020) and subsequent CMS Presidency term were substantively used to push for strengthened Central Asian Flyway coordination - a concrete instance of India using its CMS leadership position to address an institutional gap rather than a purely ceremonial hosting role.

4. Species case study: Great Indian Bustard as a cross-convention test case

- ANALYSIS: The Great Indian Bustard sits at the intersection of multiple frameworks studied across this knowledge base: IUCN Critically Endangered (Topic 05), Wildlife Protection Act Schedule I (Topic 08), and CMS-relevant migratory/range considerations for its regional movements - illustrating how a single flagship species' conservation draws on overlapping but distinct international and domestic instruments simultaneously.

- ANALYSIS: The species' primary documented threat (collision with high-voltage overhead transmission lines in its grassland habitat, subject to ongoing Supreme Court-monitored mitigation directions) is fundamentally a domestic infrastructure-siting problem rather than a classic multi-range-state migratory-cooperation problem - a useful contrast case showing that not every CMS-relevant species' primary threat is actually a "range-state coordination failure"; some are domestic implementation failures within a single country.

5. Data and conceptual limitations

- ANALYSIS: Migratory-species population and route data increasingly rely on satellite telemetry studies (e.g., WII-led tagging projects), which provide precise but necessarily sample-limited route information - broad flyway maps are informed estimates built from tagged-individual data, not a complete census of all individuals' routes.

- ANALYSIS: The distinction between a binding CMS Agreement and a non-binding MOU is sometimes blurred in general/coaching-style sources; an advanced answer should specify which instrument type applies to a cited example rather than treating all CMS cooperative instruments as equally binding.

- ANALYSIS: Comprehensive assessment of "how well" a given flyway is institutionally coordinated is qualitative and evolving; avoid asserting a precise comparative ranking between flyways without citing a specific CMS or flyway-partnership assessment document.

6. Recurring UPSC analytical tensions

Tension	Balanced framing
Binding Agreements vs voluntary MOUs	Stronger instruments offer more assurance but are harder to conclude; MOUs enable faster, broader initial cooperation that can mature into stronger instruments over time.
Domestic infrastructure-siting failure vs range-state coordination failure	Not every migratory-species threat is a multi-country coordination problem - some (like bustard power-line collisions) are primarily domestic implementation issues requiring domestic fixes.
Flyway leadership role vs institutional capacity gap	India's CMS CoP13 hosting/Presidency signals leadership intent, but translating this into a fully institutionalised, resourced Central Asian Flyway partnership remains an ongoing effort.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: CMS instruments range from binding Appendix I obligations and binding Agreements to

non-binding Appendix II encouragement and non-binding MOUs - a graduated cooperation toolkit, not a single uniform obligation level.

- FACT: India hosted CMS CoP13 in Gandhinagar, Gujarat (2020) and held the subsequent CMS Presidency, using it to push Central Asian Flyway coordination.

- FACT: The Central Asian Flyway passes through India and has historically had a less formalised institutional architecture compared to some other major global flyways.

- FACT: The Great Indian Bustard's primary documented threat (power-line collision) is a domestic infrastructure-siting issue, distinct from a classic range-state-coordination failure.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: All CMS-listed species are protected through the same binding legal mechanism. -> CMS uses a graduated toolkit - binding Appendix I duties, binding Agreements, non-binding Appendix II encouragement and non-binding MOUs - with differing legal weight.

- WRONG: The Central Asian Flyway has an equally formalised, long-standing institutional partnership as other major global flyways. -> It has historically had a comparatively less formalised coordination architecture, an active area of CMS-linked strengthening efforts.

- WRONG: Every threat to a CMS-listed migratory species is necessarily a multi-country coordination failure. -> Some threats (e.g., the bustard's power-line collision risk) are primarily domestic infrastructure/implementation issues.

- WRONG: India's CMS CoP13 hosting was a purely ceremonial, one-time event with no follow-on role. -> India held the subsequent CMS Presidency term and used it substantively for Central Asian Flyway coordination efforts.

9. CURRENT: Current anchor - analytical use

CURRENT: **Latest completed COP:** CMS COP14 (Samarkand, 2024) adopted the 2024-2032 strategic plan, launched the first global migratory-species status report and advanced Central Asian Flyway coordination in India. COP13 remains India's prior hosting/presidency context. CMS source.

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
FACT: Historical context: CMS COP13 (Gandhinagar, 2020) and India's subsequent Presidency term.	Use as evidence of prior leadership, not as the latest COP; pair it with the COP14 Central Asian Flyway outcome above.
CURRENT: The first <i>State of the World's Migratory Species</i> report (launched at CMS COP14, Samarkand, February 2024) is the first global stocktake of CMS-listed species. ANALYSIS: Cite its specific percentages only from the report itself - this file deliberately does not reproduce them from memory.	Its structural finding is the usable one: a large share of CMS-listed species show declining population trends, and fish are the worst-affected CMS-listed group , because migratory fish face barriers (dams, weirs), overexploitation and pollution across an entire river or ocean basin. Use it to argue that river-connectivity policy (Topic 14) is migratory-species policy.
FACT: Amur Falcon and Pangti/Doyang, Nagaland - the standard Indian case of a community-led reversal, where large-scale trapping of a long-distance migrant at its stopover was replaced by community protection and roost-based ecotourism.	The counterweight to the Great Indian Bustard case: the bustard shows a <i>domestic infrastructure</i> failure; the Amur Falcon shows a <i>domestic community-institution success</i> on a species whose survival depends on range states from north-east Asia to southern Africa. Together they let an answer argue that CMS's weakest-link problem is solved locally, not only diplomatically.

ANALYSIS: **Announced vs achieved discipline:** the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032 sets *targets*; it is not evidence of improved species status. Never present the adoption of a strategic plan as a conservation outcome.

| CURRENT: Supreme Court-monitored Great Indian Bustard power-line mitigation proceedings (verify latest order date). | Use as the domestic-implementation contrast case to the range-state-coordination framing of typical CMS problems. |

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions distinguishing CMS Appendix I/II obligations from Agreements/MOUs

should be solved by applying the graduated binding-versus-voluntary toolkit logic.

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on migratory-species conservation should explicitly identify whether the cited threat is a range-state-coordination problem (requiring CMS-type cooperation) or a domestic-implementation problem (requiring purely national fixes) to show precise analytical framing.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: CMS provides a graduated, flexible toolkit (from binding Appendix I duties to voluntary MOUs) for the fundamentally "weakest-link" problem of migratory-species conservation, and India's active leadership (CMS CoP13 hosting/Presidency) has been substantively directed at strengthening the comparatively under-institutionalised Central Asian Flyway - but not every migratory-species threat is a range-state-coordination failure, and analytically sound answers must distinguish coordination failures from purely domestic implementation failures (as in the Great Indian Bustard's power-line collision case).

1. Define CMS's range-state logic and its graduated instrument toolkit (Appendix I/II, Agreements, MOUs).
2. Use the Central Asian Flyway as a case study of an under-institutionalised cooperation architecture and India's CoP13/Presidency-driven strengthening effort.
3. Distinguish range-state-coordination failures from domestic-implementation failures using the Great Indian Bustard case as the contrast example.
4. Flag the data/institutional-assessment limitations (telemetry sampling, qualitative flyway-comparison claims).
5. Conclude with a dual-track recommendation: strengthen flyway-level institutional architecture where the problem is genuinely transboundary, and fix domestic infrastructure/implementation gaps where it is not.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Distinguish CMS Agreements from CMS Memoranda of Understanding by legal weight and give an example of each.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Why is the Central Asian Flyway considered less institutionally developed than other major global flyways, and what has India done to address this?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Using the Great Indian Bustard case, distinguish between range-state-coordination failures and domestic-implementation failures in migratory-species conservation.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/10_CMS-Bonn-Convention-Migratory-Species.md`.
- FACT: `05_IUCN-Red-List-and-Endemism.md` - the Great Indian Bustard case in full risk-assessment and legal-layer detail.
- FACT: `09_CITES-and-Wildlife-Trade.md` - the trade-focused counterpart, contrasted with CMS's range-state/habitat focus.
- FACT: `28_Species-and-Current-Affairs-Tracker.md` - dated updates on flyway coordination and species-specific developments.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species: MIGRATORY-SPECIES, RANGE, RANGE-STATE AND APPENDIX MAP

1. **Migratory-species test:** The CMS Convention text defines a migratory species through a significant proportion of members cyclically and predictably crossing one or more national jurisdictional boundaries; merely moving within one landscape is not enough.
2. **Range definition:** A migratory range includes land or water inhabited, used temporarily, crossed or overflowed on the normal migration route; breeding and wintering sites are not the only relevant places.
3. **Range State definition:** A Range State exercises jurisdiction over any part of that range, with the Convention text also addressing relevant flag-vessel situations; it is not limited to the breeding State or final destination.
4. **Weakest-link logic:** Because the life cycle spans route segments and jurisdictions, loss at one breeding, stopover, wintering or passage site can undermine protection elsewhere; CMS is a coordination response to that transboundary problem.
5. **Appendix I:** Appendix I lists endangered migratory species and requires Range States to endeavour to conserve or restore important habitat, address migration obstacles and prohibit taking subject only to precise Convention exceptions.
6. **Taking exceptions:** Appendix I exceptions for taking must fit the Convention grounds and remain precise in content and limited in space and time; an exception is not a general permission.
7. **Appendix II:** Appendix II covers migratory species with unfavourable conservation status requiring agreements and species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation; it opens a cooperation route rather than duplicating Appendix I.
8. **Dual listing:** The Convention expressly permits a migratory species to be listed in both Appendix I and Appendix II because strict protection and cooperative agreement serve different functions.
9. **AGREEMENT architecture:** A CMS AGREEMENT should cover the whole range, remain open to Range States and address coordinated conservation, monitoring, information exchange, habitat networks and obstacles as applicable.
10. **Agreement versus MOU:** A binding Agreement and a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding must be identified by the exact instrument; neither an Appendix listing nor an Action Plan proves that one of those instruments exists.
11. **Action Plan boundary:** An Action Plan can organise conservation measures for a species or flyway, but its legal and institutional status must be read from the adopting instrument; plan adoption is not a recovery outcome.
12. **Concerted Action boundary:** CMS Concerted Actions prioritise focused cooperative work between COPs; they do not replace Appendix status, an Agreement, an MOU or domestic legal protection.
13. **Central Asian Flyway:** The flyway is an ecological route and cooperation geography, not itself a species, Appendix or treaty; every claim about its institution, Range States or action plan requires the dated official instrument.
14. **COP14 initiative:** The official CMS COP14 release states that Samarkand in February 2024 adopted a Central Asian Flyway initiative including a coordinating unit in India with Indian Government financial support; it must be called an initiative, not silently upgraded to an Agreement or MOU.
15. **Strategic plan status:** COP14 adopted the Samarkand Strategic Plan for Migratory Species 2024-2032; adoption establishes targets and direction, not proof that populations, habitats or route safety improved.
16. **Threat classification:** Habitat loss, taking, barriers, power lines, light pollution, bycatch and other pressures must be located on the route; some are transboundary coordination failures and others are domestic implementation failures.
17. **Amur Falcon PYQ anchor:** The provisional 2026 routed demand concerns Amur Falcon migration to Doyang Lake and community-based conservation; it is carried as an answer-free concept anchor without inferring the option key.

18. **Amur Falcon distinction:** The Doyang or Pangti conservation example illustrates protection of a stopover or roost link through local action; it does not by itself prove protection across the species' complete migratory circuit.
19. **CMS-CITES-Ramsar split:** CMS coordinates migratory-range conservation, CITES regulates international trade and Ramsar concerns wetland wise use and designation; one migratory bird can engage all three without merging their legal effects.
20. **Current-listing boundary:** The package does not assert a current species Appendix, Party count, MOU signatory count or post-COP14 action-plan status unless it was substantively retrieved from the dated official source.

CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species: AGREEMENT, MOU, ACTION-PLAN, FLYWAY AND OUTCOME TRAPS

- Do not call every mobile or seasonally shifting animal a CMS migratory species.
- Do not reduce range to breeding and destination sites.
- Do not restrict Range State to the State where breeding occurs.
- Do not treat Appendix I exceptions as a general taking permission.
- Do not say Appendix II creates the same duty as Appendix I.
- Appendix I and II are not mutually exclusive; dual listing serves separate functions.
- Do not treat every CMS instrument as legally binding.
- Do not call an Action Plan an Agreement or MOU without the instrument.
- Do not convert a Concerted Action into an Appendix amendment.
- Do not call the Central Asian Flyway a treaty.
- Do not upgrade the COP14 initiative to a binding Agreement.
- Do not report a strategic-plan target as a conservation outcome.
- Do not classify every threat as a transboundary failure.
- Do not infer the 2026 provisional PYQ key.
- Do not invent a current Appendix or membership count.

CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species: CMS ANSWER SPINE

APPLY THE CYCLICAL AND PREDICTABLE CROSS-BOUNDARY TEST

- > MAP THE COMPLETE RANGE AND EVERY MATERIAL RANGE STATE
- > DISTINGUISH APPENDIX I, APPENDIX II AND DUAL LISTING
- > NAME THE EXACT AGREEMENT, MOU, ACTION PLAN OR CONCERTED ACTION
- > LOCATE EACH THREAT AS TRANSBOUNDARY OR DOMESTIC
- > USE AMUR FALCON AS A LOCAL LINK, NOT WHOLE-ROUTE PROOF
- > CONCLUDE WITH SYNCHRONISED RANGE-STATE AND LOCAL IMPLEMENTATION

CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species: LIVE COP, LISTING, INSTRUMENT AND PROVISIONAL-PYQ BOUNDARY

The CMS Convention text and official COP14 outcome release were substantively retrieved on 2026-09-06. They support definitions, Appendix mechanics, AGREEMENT design, the dated Central Asian Flyway initiative and strategic-plan adoption. No current Appendix species list, Party count, MOU count or implementation outcome was inferred.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Migratory-species gate

MOVEMENT OBSERVED -> ask whether it crosses national jurisdiction
PATTERN -> significant proportion crosses cyclically and predictably
YES -> CMS migratory-species test may be met
NO -> mobility alone does not establish CMS status
VERIFY -> use the taxon and current Appendix record
MUST REMEMBER: CMS conserves migratory species across range states through appendices and...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Range geography

BREEDING SITE -> life-cycle stage
PASSAGE AND STOPOVER -> temporary habitat and route link
WINTERING OR FEEDING SITE -> another life-cycle stage
OVERFLIGHT OR WATER ROUTE -> also within Convention range
RULE -> conserve the connected circuit, not only endpoints

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Range State map

STATE A -> breeding jurisdiction
STATE B -> passage or stopover jurisdiction
STATE C -> wintering jurisdiction
FLAG STATE -> relevant taking beyond national limits where applicable
CMS TASK -> coordinate every material jurisdiction

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Appendix I duty chain

ENDANGERED MIGRATORY SPECIES -> Appendix I
HABITAT -> conserve and restore where feasible and appropriate
OBSTACLES -> prevent, remove, compensate for or minimize
TAKING -> prohibit subject to narrow Convention exceptions
EXCEPTION -> precise content plus space-and-time limits

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Appendix II cooperation chain

UNFAVOURABLE STATUS OR SIGNIFICANT BENEFIT -> Appendix II
RANGE STATES -> endeavour to conclude AGREEMENTS
WHOLE RANGE -> agreement design objective
COORDINATION -> habitat, monitoring, information and threats
RULE -> cooperation route is not Appendix I duplication

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Dual-listing matrix

APPENDIX I -> endangered status and immediate protection duties
APPENDIX II -> international-cooperation and agreement route
BOTH -> expressly possible under Article IV
NOT HIERARCHY -> functions overlap without cancelling each other
ANSWER -> state each consequence separately
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Appendix I and II have distinct consequences, CMS is not CITES, range...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Instrument-status ladder

APPENDIX -> Convention listing status
AGREEMENT -> identify exact binding instrument
MOU -> identify exact non-binding instrument
ACTION PLAN -> planned measures under its adopting authority
CONCERTED ACTION -> priority cooperative work between COPs

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: AGREEMENT design rail

SCOPE -> whole migratory range
ACCESS -> open to relevant Range States
SCIENCE -> status review, research and information exchange
HABITAT -> network, restoration and obstacle response
GOVERNANCE -> authority, monitoring, reporting and coordination

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Central Asian Flyway firewall

FLYWAY -> ecological migration geography
INITIATIVE -> COP14 cooperation arrangement
COORDINATING UNIT -> official release locates it in India
AGREEMENT OR MOU -> not inferred
OUTCOME -> not inferred from institutional adoption

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Plan-versus-outcome gate

COP14 -> Samarkand, February 2024
STRATEGIC PLAN -> 2024-2032 direction and targets
INITIATIVE -> Central Asian Flyway coordination step
MONITORING -> needed for implementation evidence
RULE -> adoption is an output, not species recovery

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Threat-location matrix

ROUTE-WIDE -> habitat network, taking and shared data
DOMESTIC -> power line, wetland loss or local enforcement
LOCAL SUCCESS -> Doyang or Pangti stopover protection
LIMIT -> one repaired link does not prove whole-route safety
RESPONSE -> match institution to threat location

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: PYQ and convention spine

DEFINE -> migratory species, range and Range State
CLASSIFY -> Appendix I, II or both
NAME -> Agreement, MOU, Action Plan or Concerted Action
APPLY -> Amur Falcon answer-free route-and-community concept
SEPARATE -> CMS, CITES, Ramsar and current-listing evidence
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Verify membership, appendix, taxon, range...